

GOTO **COPENHAGEN**

Craft software with confidence in 2026



AI as an Amplifier

State of AI-assisted Software
Development

These are not the DORAs you're looking for

DORA





Research into the capabilities that enable technology-driven teams and organizations to thrive.

Get better at getting better.

**More than a
decade of
research**

**DO
RA**

Performance

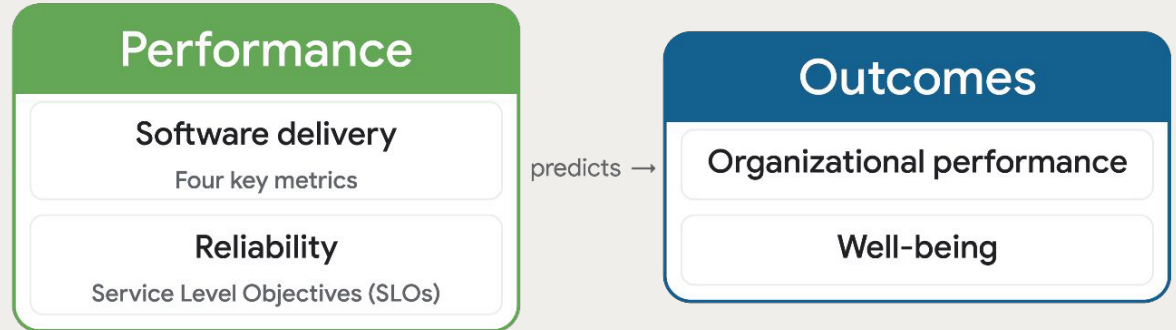
Software delivery

Four key metrics

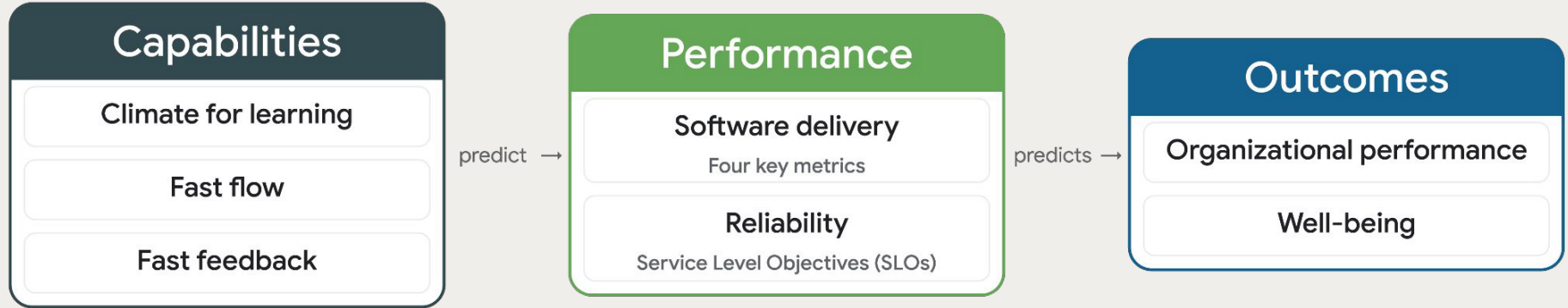
Reliability

Service Level Objectives (SLOs)

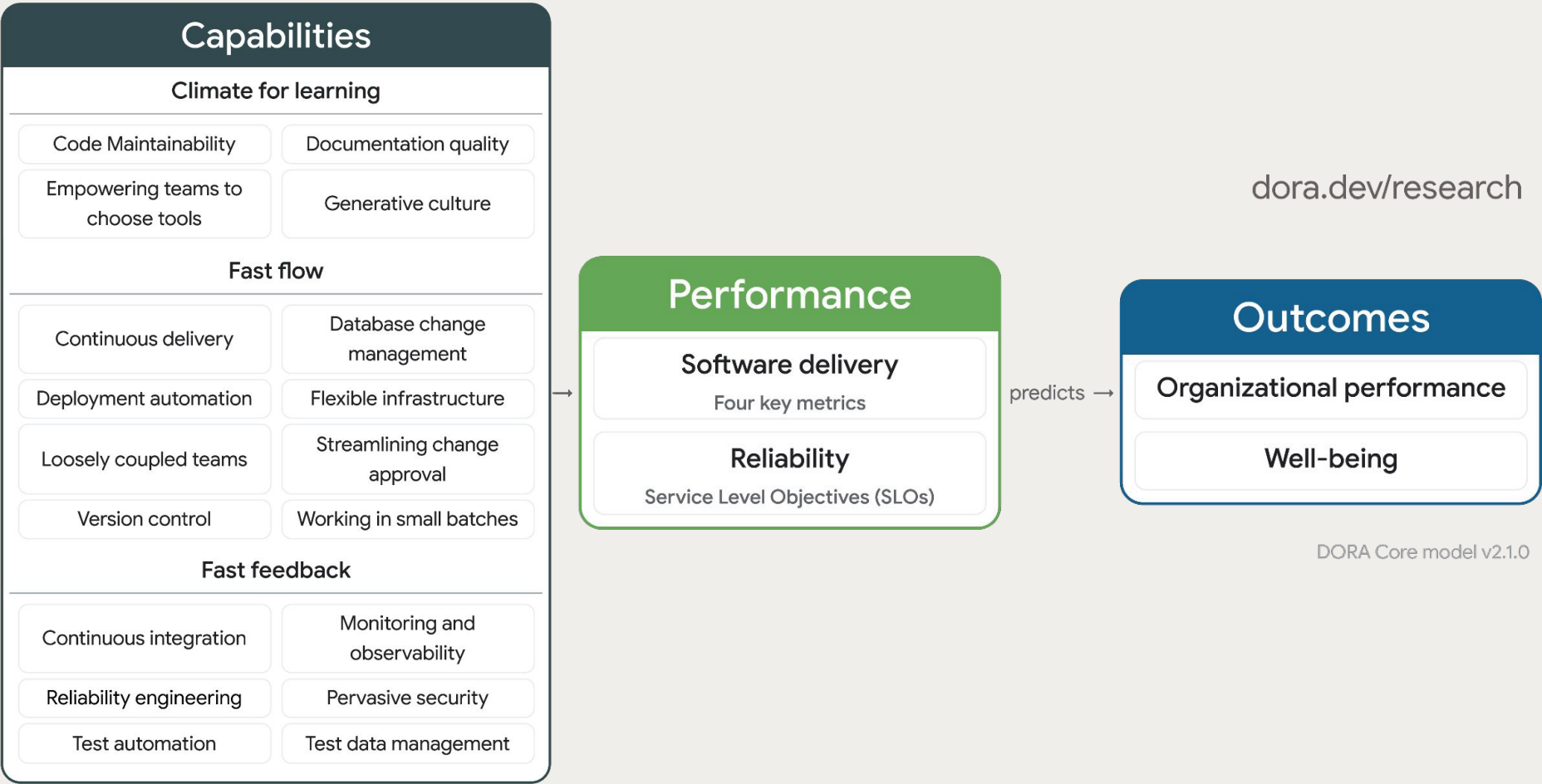
dora.dev/research



DORA Core model v2.1.0

**DO
RA** Core Modeldora.dev/research

DORA Core model v2.1.0

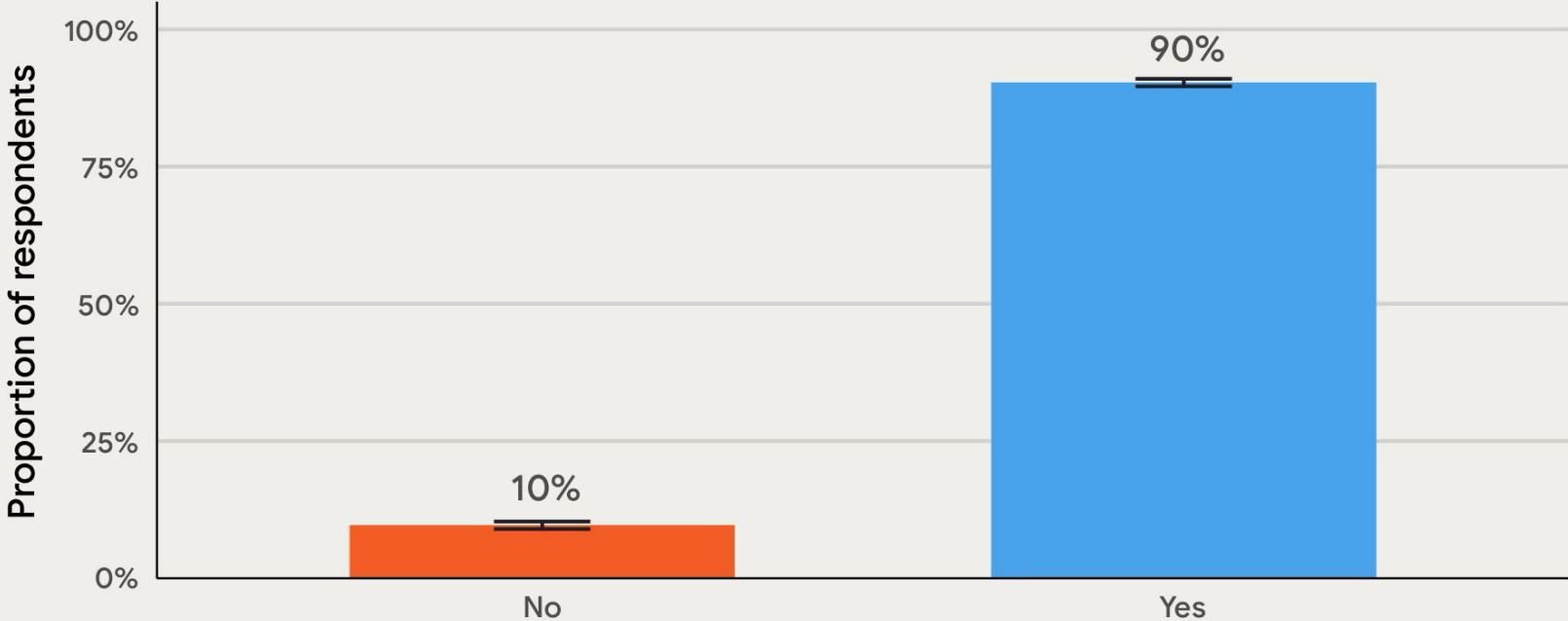




**AI adoption
and use**

AI adoption

Proportion of respondents who use AI at work

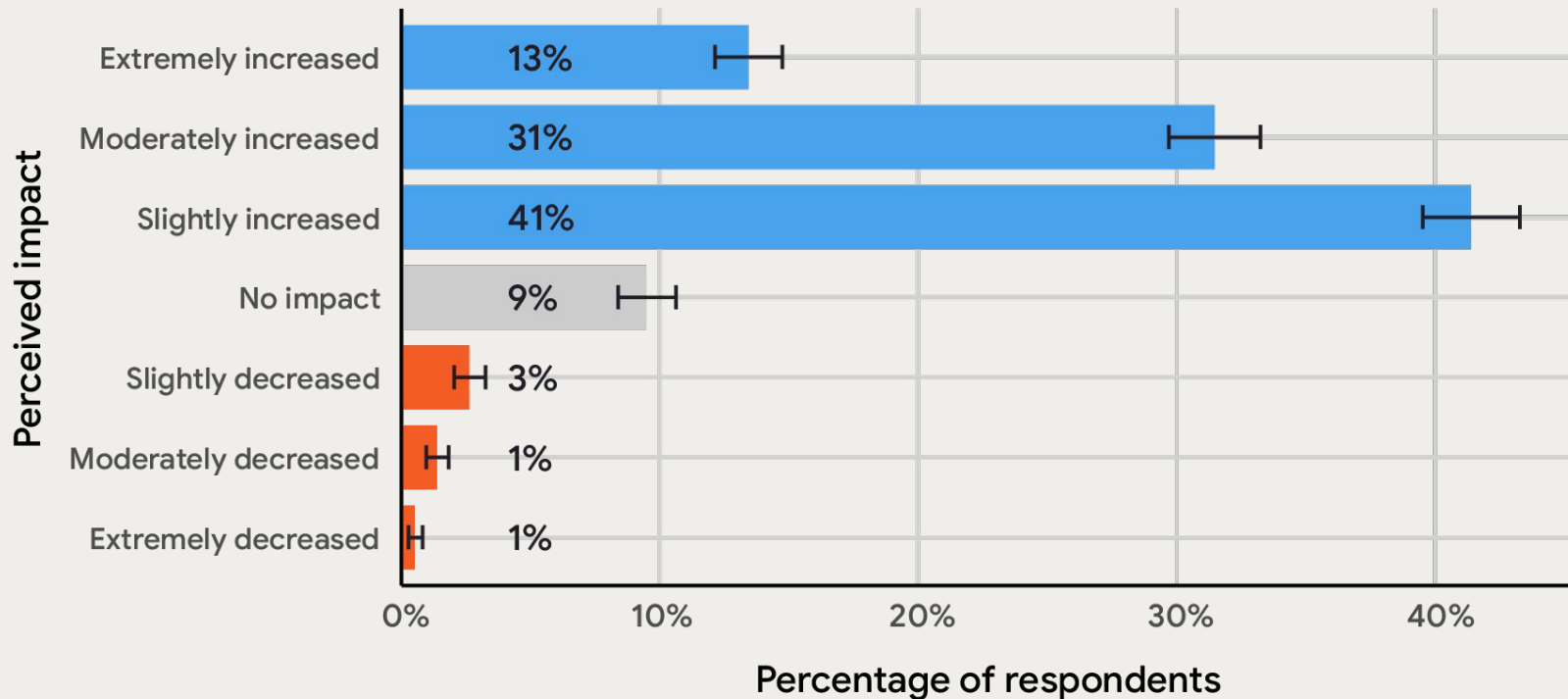


Error bars show the 89% credible interval.

Perceived impact on individual productivity

DORA

Respondents' assessment of how AI affects their productivity

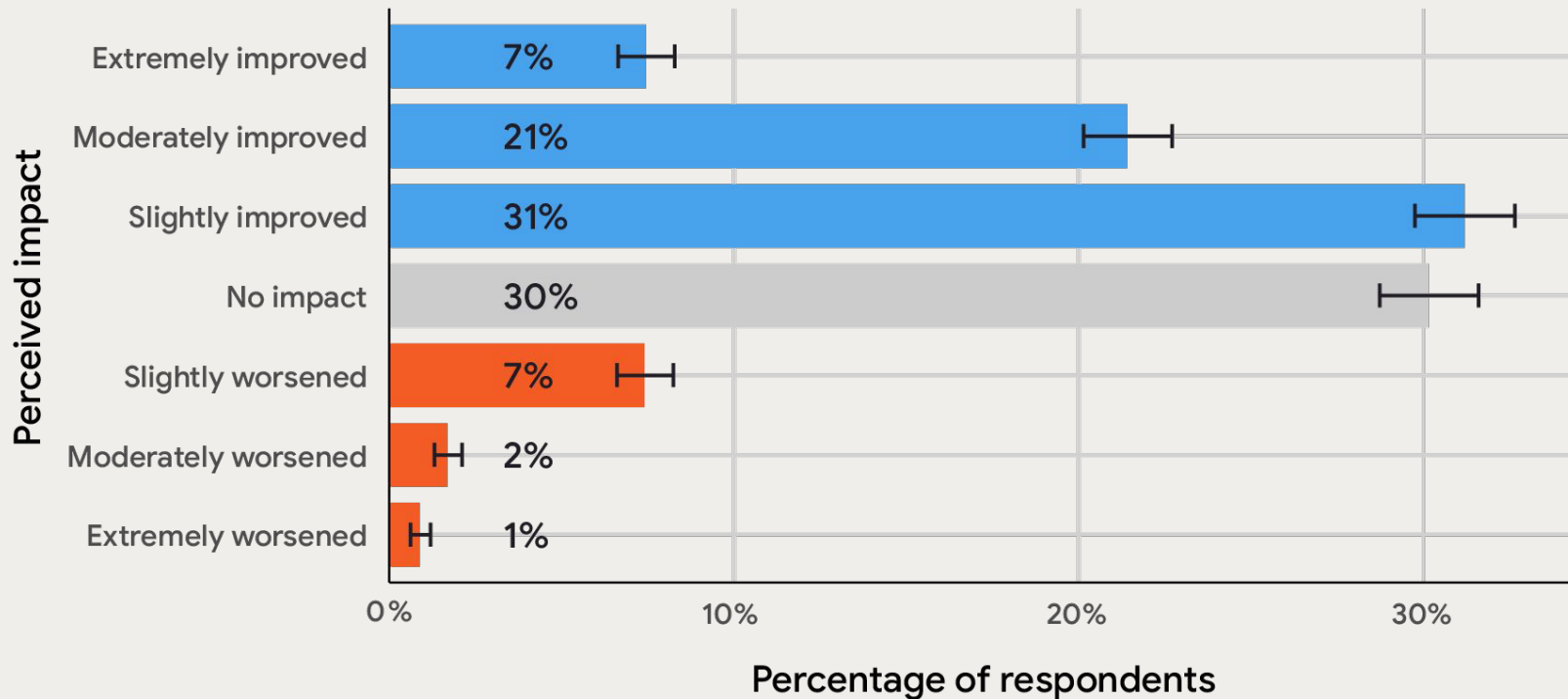


Error bars show the 89% credible interval.

Perceived impact on code quality

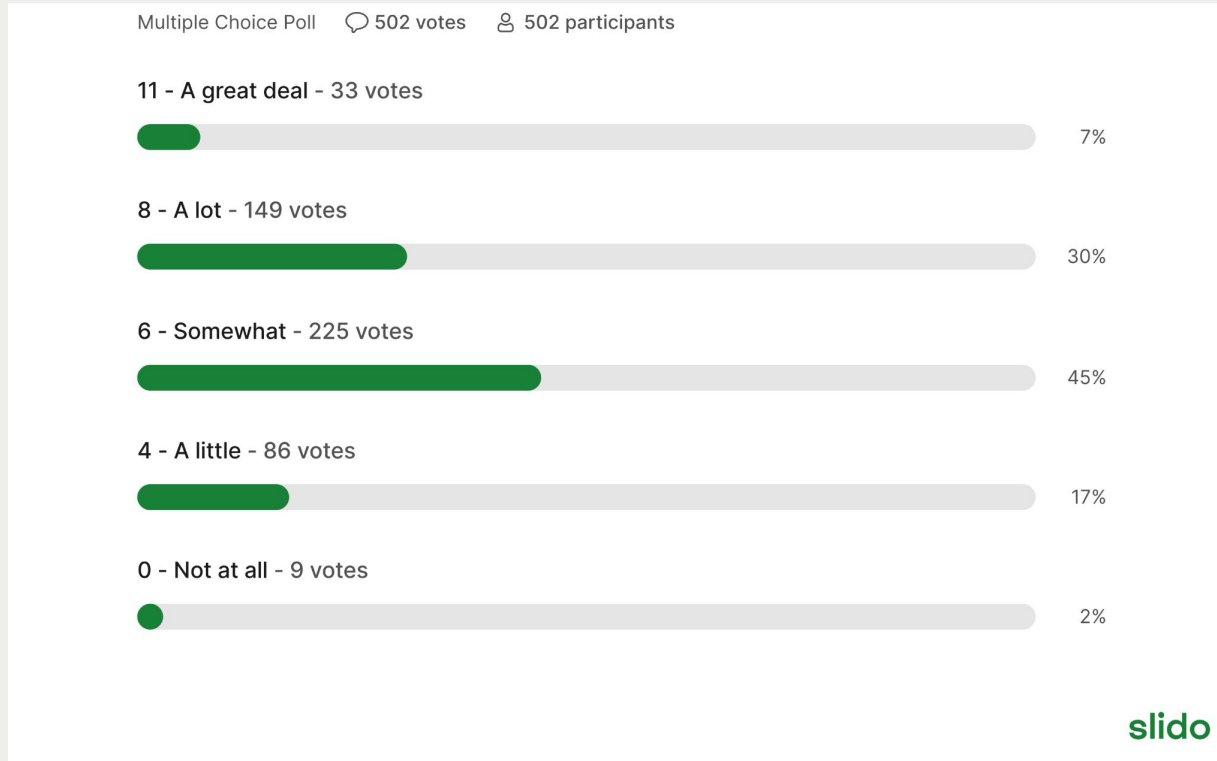
DORA

Respondents' assessment of how AI affects their code quality



Error bars show the 89% credible interval.

In the last 3 months, how much did you trust the quality of AI-generated output at work?



**AI's primary role in
software development
is that of an amplifier.**

**DO
RA**

**The greatest returns on
AI investment come
from a strategic focus
on the underlying
organizational system.**

**DO
RA**

**Without this
foundation, AI creates
localized pockets of
productivity that are
often lost to
downstream chaos.**

**DO
RA**



Unlock software delivery performance with faster code reviews

Speeding up code reviews is one of the most effective paths to improving software delivery performance. Teams with faster code reviews have 50% higher software delivery performance.

Early AI findings: 2023

- Slightly improves individual well-being
- Neutral to negative effect on group-level outcomes

Artificial intelligence (AI)

Some analysts and technologists hypothesize that AI will make software teams more performant without negatively affecting professional well-being. So far our survey evidence doesn't support this. Our evidence suggests that AI slightly improves individual well-being measures (such as burnout and job satisfaction) but has a neutral or perhaps negative effect on group-level outcomes (such as team performance and software delivery performance).







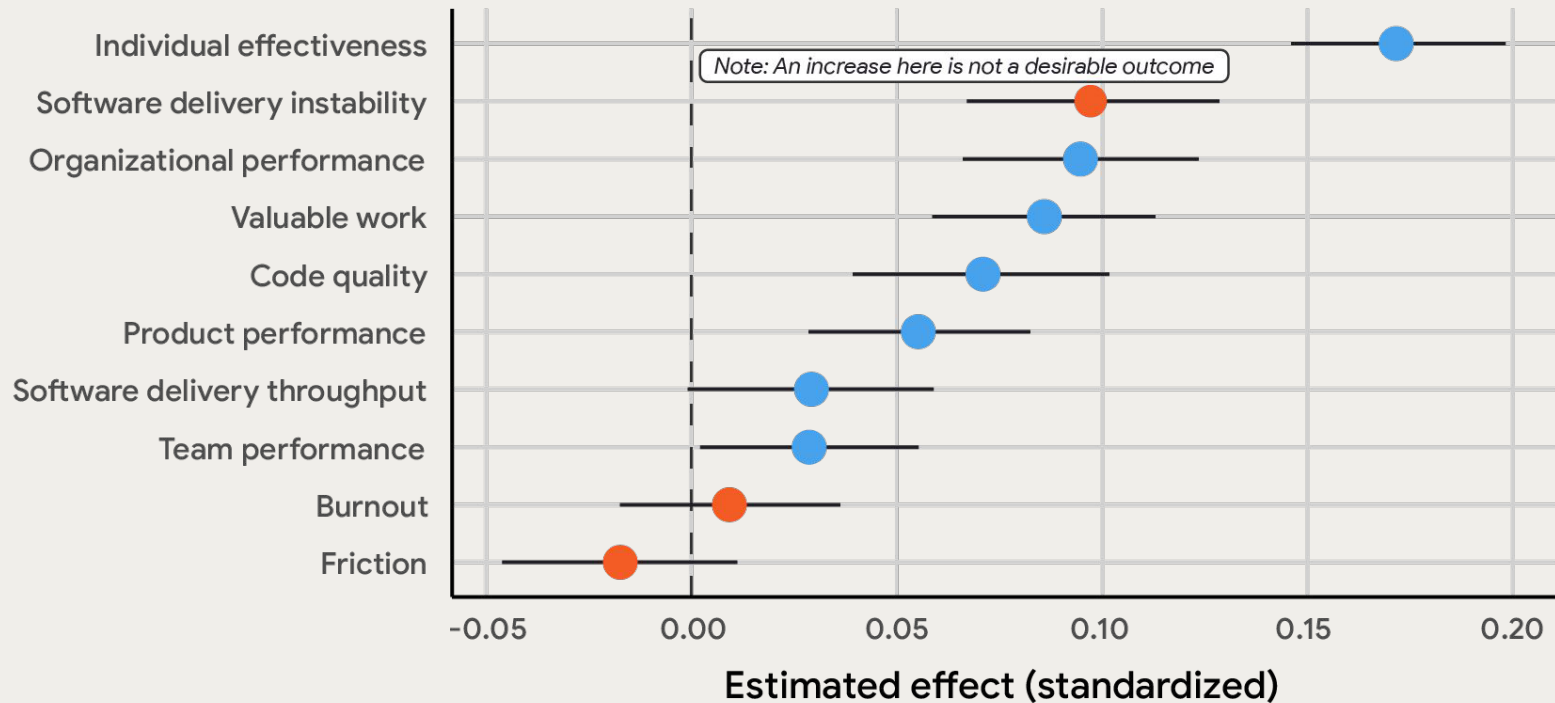
WE ARE
HERE



**Exploring AI's
relationship to
key outcomes**

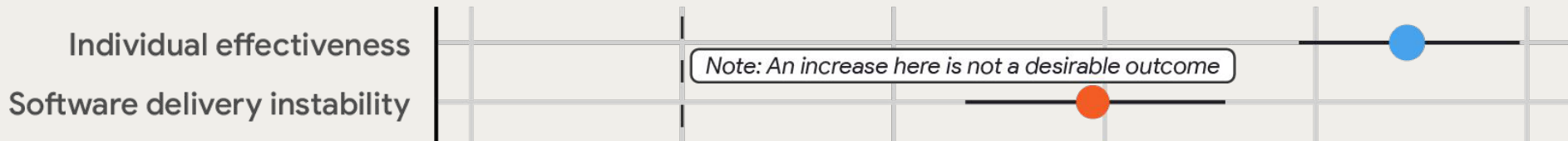
AI's impact

Estimated effect of AI adoption on key outcomes, with 89% credible intervals



For outcomes in orange (e.g., Burnout), a negative effect is desirable.
<https://dora.dev/dora-report-2025>

AI's impact



Welcome,
builders



What's stopping you from YOLO'ing that solution into production?

Wordcloud Poll 408 responses 318 participants



Turn those fears into your roadmap

Harness engineering with both **feed forward** and **feedback** mechanisms:

- Trust
- Experience
- Governance and compliance
- Accelerated, quality feedback
- Observability



DORA AI
capabilities
model

DORA AI capabilities

DORA



Clear and
communicated
AI stance



Healthy data
ecosystems



AI-accessible
internal data



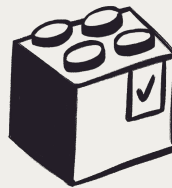
Strong version
control practices



Working in
small batches



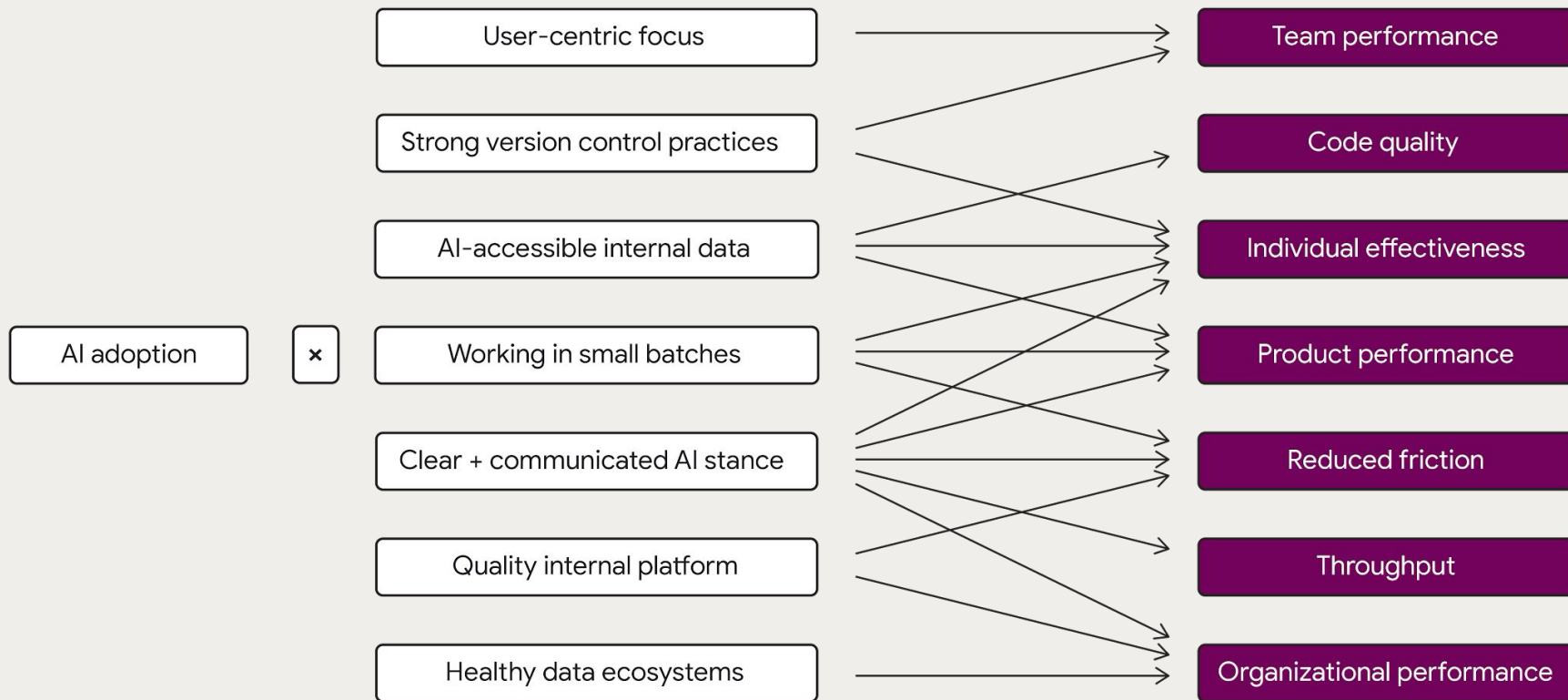
User-centric
focus



Quality
internal
platforms

DORA AI Capabilities Model

DORA



DORA AI
Capabilities
Model in action



DORA AI Capabilities Model

DORA

Product performance

ai.dora.dev

DORA AI Capabilities Model

DORA

AI adoption

Product performance

DORA AI Capabilities Model

DORA

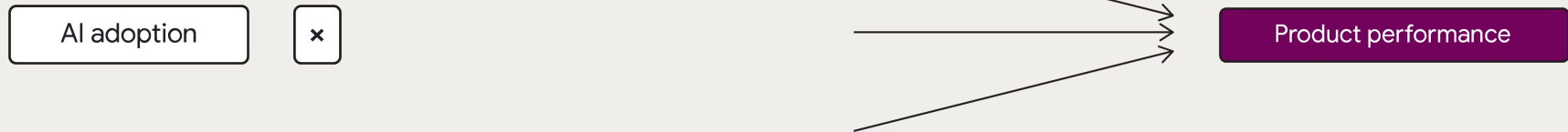
AI adoption

×

Product performance

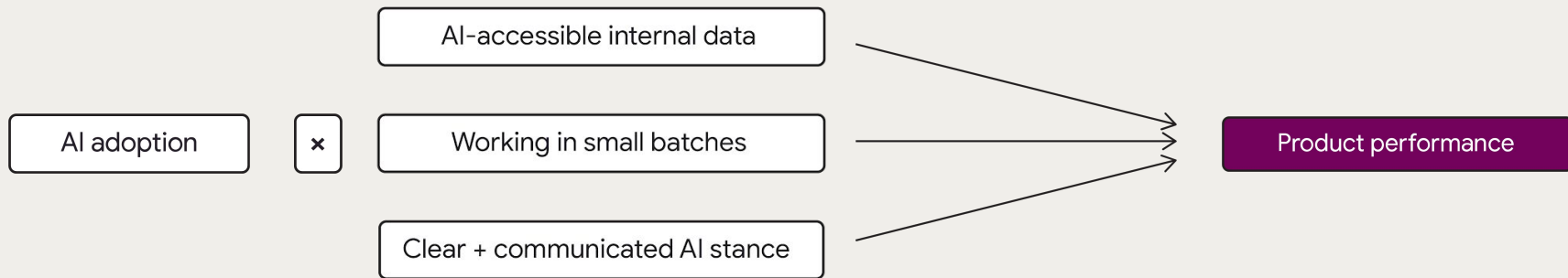
DORA AI Capabilities Model

DORA



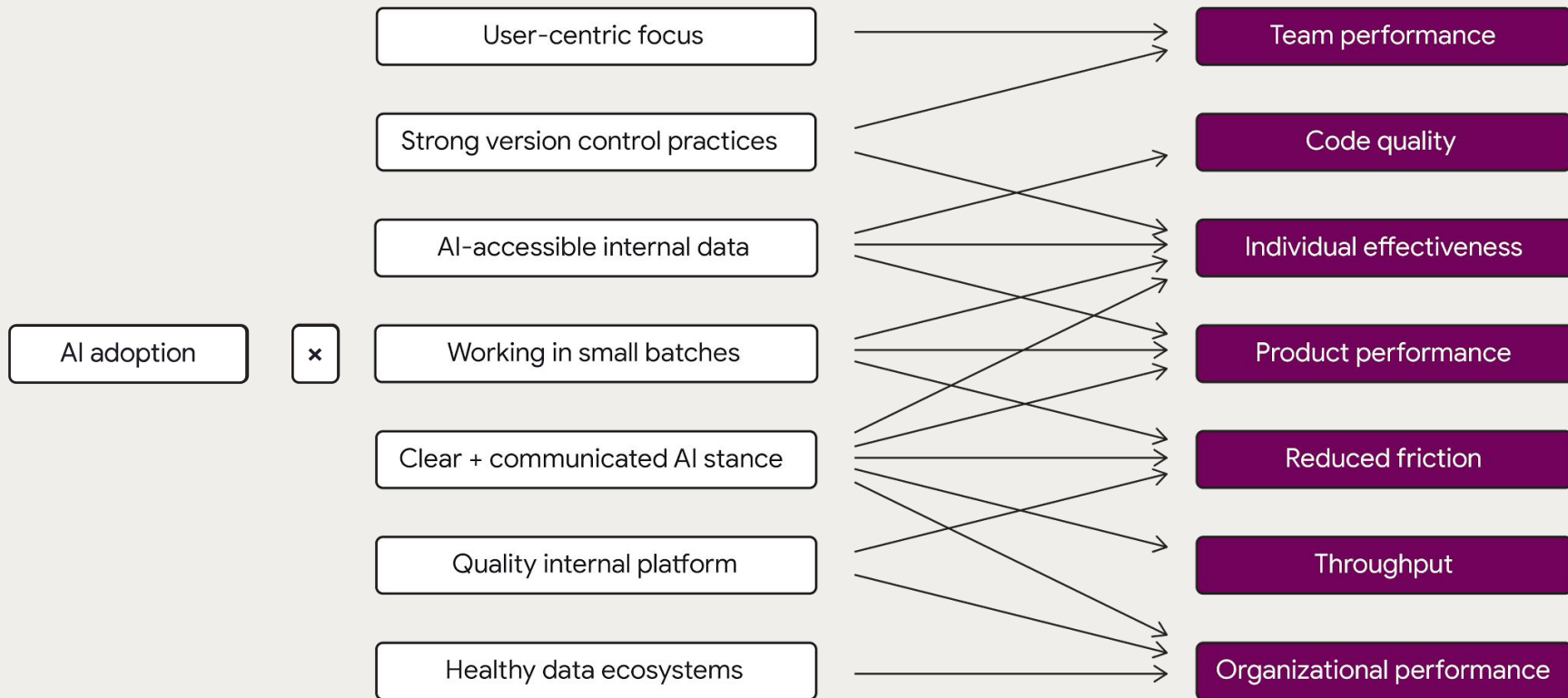
DORA AI Capabilities Model

DORA



DORA AI Capabilities Model

DORA

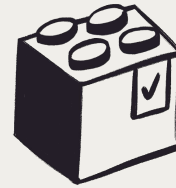


DORA AI capabilities

DORA



User-centric
focus



Quality
internal
platforms

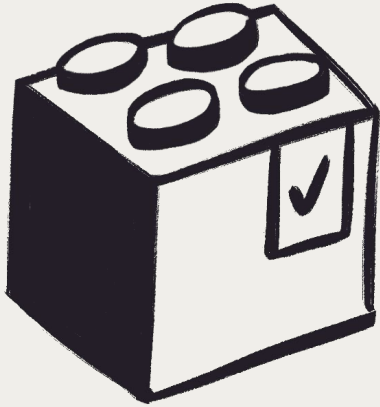
User-centric focus



All software is made for human users. The true worth of any technology, from a highly visible front-end interface to an unseen back-end process, is determined by its usefulness to the individual at the conclusion of the value chain.

- Increased team performance
- Prevention of decreased team performance

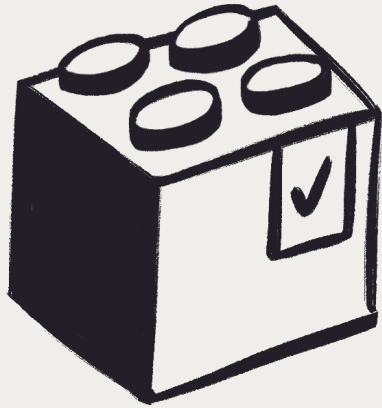
Quality internal platforms



A high-quality internal platform provides the automated, standardized, and secure pathways necessary to turn AI's potential into **systemic, organizational improvements**.

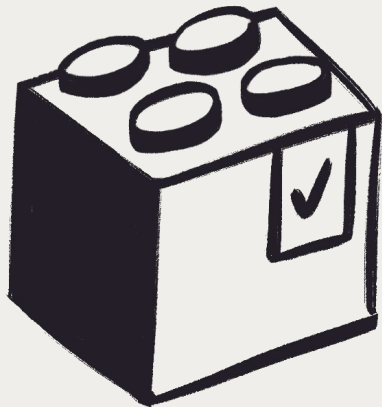
- Increased organizational performance

Proactively reduce cognitive load



A well-architected platform provides essential **guardrails and context.**

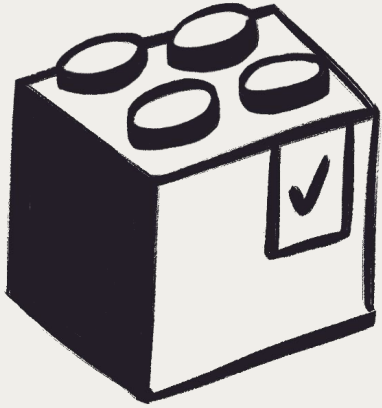
Invest in platform health



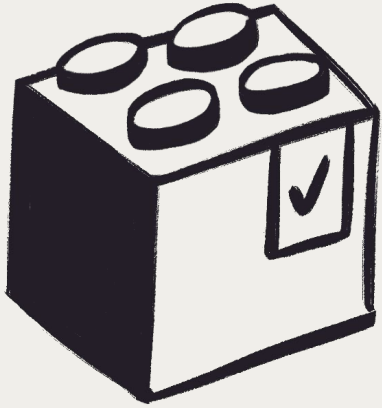
High-quality platforms act as the connective tissue for scaling AI value.

Building a user-centric platform **reduces friction** by providing standardized workflows and **self-service capabilities**.

Platform as a product

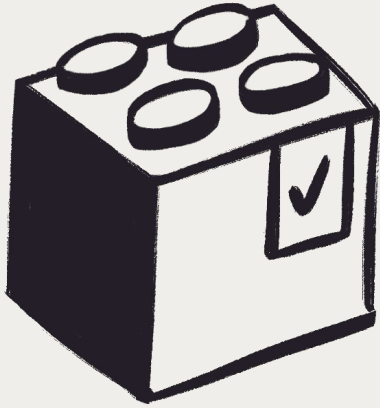


Platform as a product: Who are your customers?

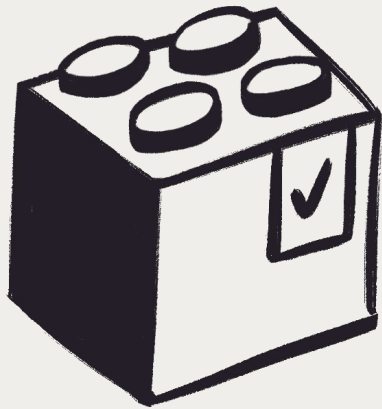


Platform as a product: Who are your customers?

Developers



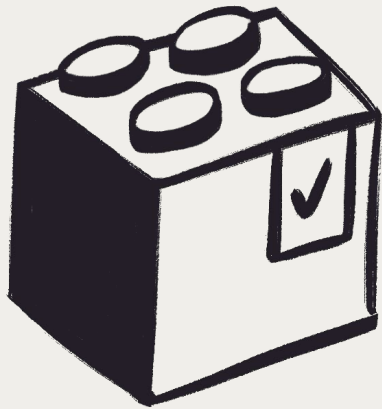
Platform as a product: Who are your customers?



Developers

Agents

Platform as a product: Who are your customers?



Developers

Agents

Builders

Wait! Not everyone wants to be a builder

DORA

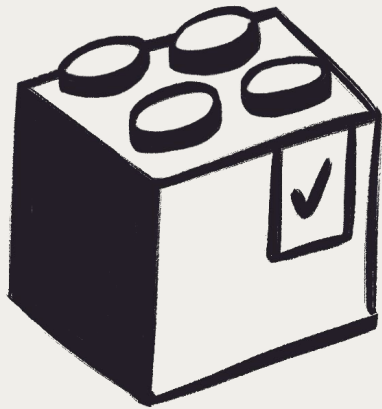
Not everyone wants to be a builder

DORA

Wed, Sep 16 at 7:13 PM

Hi - I sent you an email - my boss is making me take an agentic AI course - WTF is agentic AI? We had to do an intro interview with an avatar (weird) and I said I had no idea what agentic AI was! LOL

Platform as a product: Who are your customers?



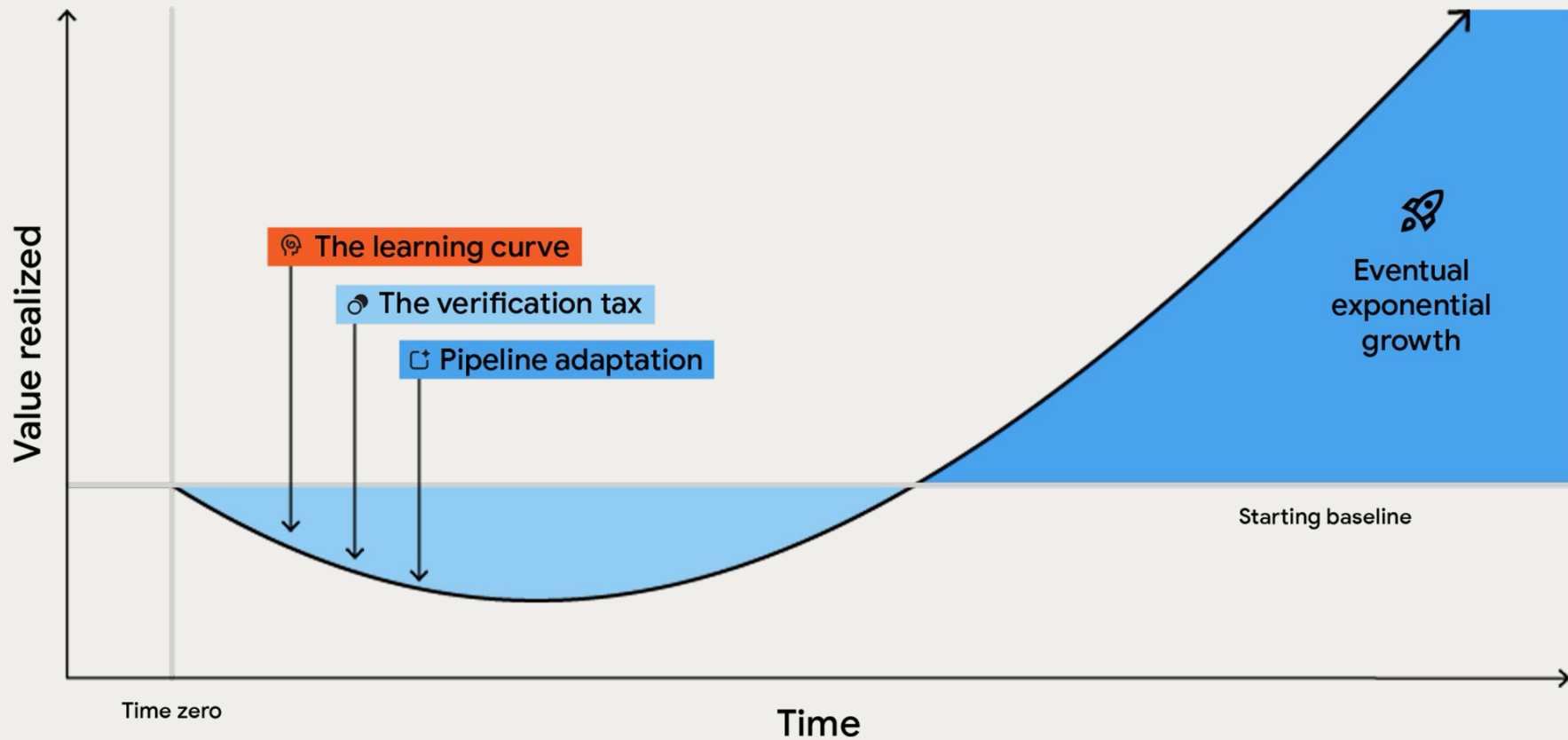
Developers

Agents

~~Builders~~ Solvers

J-Curve

DORA



Which of these is the biggest friction point in your SDLC today?

Multiple Choice Poll 441 votes 441 participants

Deciding what to build - 80 votes



18%

Building - 14 votes



3%

Reviewing changes - 220 votes



50%

Delivering to production - 45 votes



10%

Measuring impact - 82 votes



19%

Let code die



<< Let code die

Burn the backlog

<< Let code die

A detailed black and white photograph of a large, historic textile factory interior. The space is filled with rows of complex machinery, likely looms or spinning frames, where several workers in period clothing are operating. The factory has a high ceiling with a series of wooden beams and a skylight that allows natural light to enter. Large windows on the sides provide additional illumination. A large, central steam engine or motor is visible in the background. The overall atmosphere is one of industrial activity and historical significance.

WE ARE
HERE





**ROI of AI is
optionality**

***"A bad system
will beat a good
person every
time"***

- W. Edwards Deming

**DO
RA**

Build a sustainable system

Have the courage to protect platform engineering capacity.

Build an environment where AI's output can actually survive the trip to production without burning out the team.



**Get better
at getting
better**

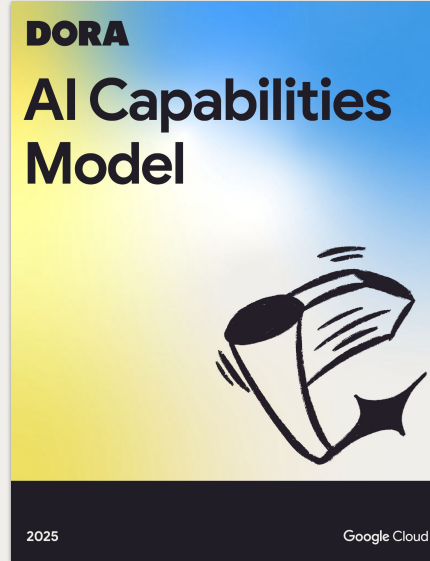
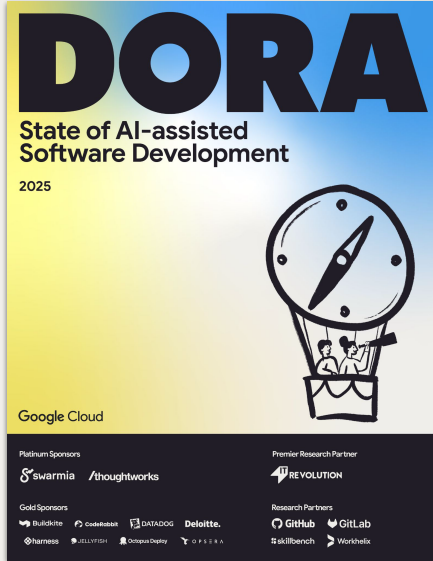
You cannot improve alone!



Join DORA.community

Download the reports

DORA





Thank you.